

Chapter 187 - Part 1

Extra 9-1

Shen Hui first saw Zhao Xuning in the school cafeteria.

The medical university had three cafeterias in total, and Shen Hui liked the one closest to their dormitory the most.

One day she went to the cafeteria alone to eat and forgot to bring her meal card.

Because she went too early, there weren't many people in the cafeteria yet. She looked around and noticed Zhao Xuning sitting quietly in a corner eating.

At that time, she was wearing a white shirt, her eyes downcast, her whole body radiating a cold and distant aura. Everything about her conveyed one message—don't come talk to me.

Actually, there were quite a few beautiful people at their school, but not many who were beautiful enough to be remembered at first sight.

And Zhao Xuning's appearance was beautiful to the point of being stunning at first glance.

Perhaps her looks weren't the most outstanding, but her temperament definitely was.

Only her area in the entire cafeteria maintained absolute silence.

Even though her phone was right beside her utensils, she would never look at her phone while eating—it was always face down.

Shen Hui stared at her for a while, suddenly remembering something her roommate had mentioned before.

They said there was a girl in their major who was young, beautiful, and quite arrogant. When a senior came to find her, she immediately said: "Sorry, I don't like men."

Later, that guy awkwardly said: "Little sister, I'm an Omega."

Zhao Xuning was silent for two seconds, "Sorry, I don't like people older than me."

The guy said: "Ah? Then why don't you just directly say you don't like me."

Zhao Xuning: "Mm, I don't like you."

The guy: "...?"

Zhao Xuning's bluntness reached a terrifying level.

Shen Hui's gaze was too direct and easily noticed. Zhao Xuning quickly looked up and made eye contact with her.

Across the distance, Shen Hui could see the range of her eye movement and that appraising gaze.

Shen Hui was quite confident and smiled at her.

As a result, Zhao Xuning had no reaction at all and lowered her head to continue eating.

This instead aroused Shen Hui's desire to conquer. She tugged at the hem of her clothes, planning to go borrow a meal card from Zhao Xuning. But just as she walked over, Zhao Xuning had already picked up her tray and stood up.

Just as they were about to pass each other, Shen Hui deliberately softened her voice and asked in a low tone: "Hello, could you lend me your meal card? I'll transfer the money to you on my phone."

Zhao Xuning didn't even stop walking, heading straight for the dish return area. Her voice was cold: "There's no money left on my card."

Shen Hui: "?"

So Shen Hui watched her figure disappear.

Just like that, Shen Hui didn't eat lunch that day.

She simply felt ignored and quite embarrassed. Miss Shen, who had been beautiful all her life, couldn't accept this kind of humiliation.

When she returned to the dorm, her roommates were still discussing this legendary figure from their department.

One roommate said she saw someone confess to Zhao Xuning on the way back from picking up a package, but Zhao Xuning frowned and said: "You're not my type."

As the department's new rising candidate most likely to become the department flower¹, Zhao Xuning had broken the hearts of countless Omegas and Betas.

Shen Hui scoffed, "Is she really that good-looking? She's not even as good-looking as me."

Everyone: "..."

But they didn't say anything.

Because Shen Hui's appearance was something everyone could see—she was indeed beautiful.

Beautiful to a degree not much inferior to Zhao Xuning.

Just that Shen Hui's appearance leaned toward glamorous beauty. If she stood there without speaking or smiling, it would make people feel particularly distanced, like someone who walked out of a TV screen or painting.

Whereas Zhao Xuning was cold in personality. Clearly she had a very approachable beautiful face, but because of her expression, everyone didn't dare get too close to her.

Each had their own kind of aloofness.

Shen Hui drank some water and didn't think much more about it.

After all, she was just a stranger, so not lending her the meal card was reasonable.

Zhao Xuning probably regarded her as just another one of many people trying to strike up a conversation.

For Shen Hui, this was the first thing Shen Hui said to Zhao Xuning.

Later, after they got together, Shen Hui loved to ask her, "Do you remember when you first saw me?"

Zhao Xuning made a thoughtful expression, then after a moment answered: "During military training, when the instructor pulled you out to sing."

Shen Hui asked again: "Then what about the first thing we said to each other?"

Zhao Xuning: "...Add me on WeChat?"

That was already from that encounter at the sports field.

It was on a certain day afterward. Shen Hui was running on the sports field, while Zhao Xuning was smoking at the edge of the field, standing casually and carelessly, wearing a brown trench coat.

On Shen Hui's way to stretch, Zhao Xuning stubbed out her cigarette, put both hands in her pockets and blocked Shen Hui's path. Her voice mixed with the humidity after rain, carrying a moist quality, frivolous yet casual: "Add me on WeChat?"

Shen Hui raised an eyebrow and handed over her phone.

In Zhao Xuning's perception, this was the first thing they said to each other.

Later, when Shen Hui kept asking this question, Zhao Xuning wasn't stupid—she could always hear the implied meaning.

One day, taking advantage of Shen Hui drinking too much, Zhao Xuning got her drunk and only then coaxed and pestered her to ask. After three rounds of drinks, Shen Hui's mind was muddled and drowsy, so naturally everything spilled out like beans from a bamboo tube.

After finishing, she sat in Zhao Xuning's lap, holding Zhao Xuning's face in both hands, squishing it into a ball, and asked dissatisfied: "Why didn't you lend me your meal card then?"

Zhao Xuning didn't answer at first.

Later, after being squeezed by Shen Hui until her face was red, she told Shen Hui to let go, but Shen Hui wouldn't no matter what, even intensifying by leaning in to bite her face.

After the Nth time of having her face squeezed, Zhao Xuning helplessly grabbed her hands and kissed her face, "I also didn't know you'd become my girlfriend."

Shen Hui suddenly laughed like an idiot.

Shen Hui originally wasn't a particularly cheerful person.

If you asked her middle and high school classmates to evaluate her, they'd probably only come up with one word: glamorous.

Usually she didn't really chat with people much. When everyone joked around, she might just smile along, never participating in the jokes, but never disdaining them either.

Distant, yet close.

That kind of vague social distance.

But in front of Zhao Xuning, Shen Hui seemed to have unlimited energy.

Footnotes:

¹ Department flower (系花) - Campus slang for the most beautiful girl in a department/major, similar to "campus belle"

Chapter 187 - Part 2

Extra 9-2

Once, after Shen Hui drank too much, she nestled in Zhao Xuning's arms and said with particular grievance: "Zhao Xuning, I really like you."

Zhao Xuning just looked at her and smiled, "Mm."

"You're not answering properly." Shen Hui complained.

Zhao Xuning said: "I did answer."

Shen Hui lowered her eyes, "That's not the answer I want."

Zhao Xuning patiently asked her: "Then what do you want?"

Shen Hui looked up, her eyes red, and when she looked at her, she blinked, "You have to say, you like me too."

But Zhao Xuning wouldn't say it no matter what.

In the end, it made Shen Hui cry.

After drinking too much, Shen Hui always caused this kind of chaos.

Chasing after Zhao Xuning asking whether she loved her or not, making Zhao Xuning carry her home, first asking Zhao Xuning if she was being unreasonable, and if Zhao Xuning answered that she was, she'd get so aggrieved she'd cry.

Later, Shen Hui thought about it many times—what magic did Zhao Xuning have that made her throw herself into the fire like a moth?

It seemed like there wasn't any.

All the qualities Zhao Xuning possessed, when taken apart individually, she had encountered countless times in life.

Because Shen Hui's first twenty years of life had been too smooth sailing.

The second young lady of the Shen family, with an older sister's love and protection above, a younger brother's respect below, never bullied when out and about—everyone always showed her the kindest side of human nature.

But no one had ever been able to give her this kind of feeling.

Just looking at this person made the air around her seem sweeter.

Later, Shen Hui told Zhao Xuning: "You're really strange."

Zhao Xuning: "Mm... you're not the first to say that."

Zhao Xuning was indeed strange, never fitting in with her peers since childhood.

For people her age, she understood too much.

So she kept skipping grades. When she went to university, she was younger than everyone in her class, yet her professional abilities were very strong.

What Shen Hui originally meant as a teasing remark somehow made her hear a trace of bitterness in her answer.

So Shen Hui's words changed to: "Strange in a way that makes me especially like you."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Zhao Xuning was slow to warm up.

Going up to ask Shen Hui for her contact information was the most enthusiastic thing she'd ever done.

Later, Shen Hui asked Zhao Xuning: "Why did you ask me for my contact information?"

Zhao Xuning thought for two seconds and answered very seriously: "When I saw you running, I was thinking, if I were to date someone, that person could only be you."

"Then what about when I was singing?" Shen Hui asked: "The first time you saw me was when I was singing during military training."

Zhao Xuning gently pressed her lips together, "Want to hear the truth?"

Shen Hui nodded.

Zhao Xuning: "I wasn't wearing glasses then, couldn't see your face clearly."

Shen Hui: "?"

It was also on a certain day after they got together that Shen Hui suddenly realized Zhao Xuning was younger than her!

Like discovering a new continent, she shouted loudly: "Zhao Xuning, you're younger than me!"

At that time, Zhao Xuning was reading in the living room. Hearing this, she covered her ears, but Shen Hui directly sat on the sofa and wrapped herself around her with both hands and feet.

"You're so much younger than me." Shen Hui said matter-of-factly: "Call me elder sister."

Zhao Xuning glanced at her, as if saying—dream on.

Shen Hui reached out to pinch her ear, "Hurry up, call me elder sister."

"No." Zhao Xuning's answer was concise and her refusal firm. She turned her head away, trying to rescue her ear from Shen Hui's hand.

But Shen Hui leaned closer again, continuing to pester her: "You're younger than me, so you have to call me elder sister."

"Im—pos—si—ble."

Shen Hui crossed her arms and sat beside her. Zhao Xuning continued to read with her head lowered.

"So I'm not as interesting as a book, is that it?" Shen Hui said huffily.

Zhao Xuning immediately closed the book and stopped reading.

But she didn't say anything either.

She really was wooden, not even knowing how to say something soft.

Shen Hui poked her: "I'm angry, coax me."

Zhao Xuning turned her head and stared straight at her, "How do I coax?"

As if asking—how should I do this experiment?

Shen Hui pressed her lips together, returning to the topic: "Call me elder sister."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Zhao Xuning got up to go to the study, ignoring her.

Shen Hui got up and hugged her from behind, acting cute: "Baby, just call me once~ I want to hear it."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Finally, with no other choice, Zhao Xuning reluctantly called out "elder sister" once.

Shen Hui happily ate an extra bowl of rice that evening.

But when it came time for bed that night, Shen Hui was still watching TV. After Zhao Xuning finished her bath, she sat beside her, her hair still somewhat damp. Shen Hui pushed her shoulder: "Go get the hairdryer, I'll blow-dry your hair for you."

"No need." Zhao Xuning directly picked her up, "It's going to get wet again in a bit anyway."

Shen Hui didn't react immediately: "Huh?"

But as soon as the words left her mouth, she was carried directly to the bedroom bed, and Zhao Xuning leaned over her.

"Ah Hui." Zhao Xuning called her gently.

Shen Hui: "Mm?"

Zhao Xuning unbuttoned her pajamas, leaning close to whisper: "Have you heard this saying?"

Zhao Xuning was someone with great research spirit, so when she and Shen Hui first became intimate, she researched many different methods.

Methods that could make both of them feel comfortable.

With just gentle touches, Shen Hui was already somewhat lost, her voice becoming obscure and hoarse as she asked: "What?"

Zhao Xuning suddenly moved downward, using her mouth to undo the last button of her pajamas. That bland voice sounded in the room—

"During the day, call me elder sister..."

As soon as the words fell, Shen Hui let out a light moan as if receiving intense stimulation.

Zhao Xuning unhurriedly leaned close to her ear to finish the rest: "At night... elder sister... calls out."

The two words "elder sister" were deliberately emphasized, as if retaliating for Shen Hui making her call her elder sister all afternoon.

Shen Hui reached out to grab her hair, her fingers slowly sliding to the back of her neck, a pair of eyes turning red.

Zhao Xuning laughed softly, "Baby, still want me to call you elder sister?"

Shen Hui refused to admit defeat: "You're still younger than me."

"Is that so?" Zhao Xuning's smile widened.

Anyway, that night, Shen Hui never got to hear Zhao Xuning call her elder sister. Instead, when she got up the next day, her own voice was hoarse.